

CRITICAL SELF-TALK

SONDIM
GAMEDEV
COACHING

THE INVISIBLE DRAIN

Your negative self-talk is the voice in your head that's constantly speaking to you. Sometimes it's obvious, telling you you're behind. Other times it's a subtle anxiety—replaying conversations or comparing yourself to others.

One of the clearest signs of heavy negative self-talk is ending the day stressed or depleted, regardless of the hours you put in. Your exhaustion actually comes from pushing against that voice all day long.

THE FALSE MOTIVATOR

When the harsh voice is present, it sounds like a demanding boss. You not only believe this voice tends to be right, but you also think you need it to stay motivated.

At work, this takes a tremendous amount of energy and significantly hurts your productivity. The solution isn't managing life better; it is changing how you relate to that voice. When the pressure eases, energy and clarity return naturally.

PATTERNS TO EXPLORE

CRITICIZING OTHERS

We can't truly accept in others what we refuse to accept in ourselves. If you get mad at a friend or colleague for being messy or making mistakes, it's usually because you get mad at yourself for the exact same things. Noticing this is the first step to silencing your own inner critic.

DEFENSIVENESS

When someone's words hurt, it's usually because you already say the exact same things to yourself. You get defensive because they just said out loud what your own mind is whispering. Noticing what makes you snap is a great way to uncover your negative self-talk.

BURNOUT

Burnout is not always about the workload, instead it's often that you use "dirty fuel" to motivate yourself, like the perfectionist harsh voice in your head or fear of failure. Notice when you feel completely drained, it's a great way to spot your negative self-talk.

YOUR EXPERIMENT

Everyone changes and grows differently, that's why I recommend experiments. Trying things out is the best way to see what's actually effective for you right now. Here's one for you to try.

LAUNCH ONLINE TOOL

OR PEN & PAPER

THE VOICE IN YOUR HEAD

TIME: 10 MIN

STEP 1: TRANSCRIBE

Write down every thought you have for your selected time without filtering yourself.

STEP 2: REVIEW

Afterwards you mark the ones that feel self-critical or judgemental, anything you wouldn't say to a friend.

STEP 3: REPEAT

Read the list back at the end of the exercise to fully recognize the tone of your inner voice. Repeat this entire process 3 times this week.